University of Kent

Kent Business School

BUSB4011

Business Skills for a Sustainable Tomorrow

2025/2026

Contents

Section 1: Key Contacts **3**
Section 2: Module Overview **4**
2.1. Module Title 4
2.3. Learning Outcomes 4
2.4. Developing graduate attributes 4
2.5 Developing Ethics and Sustainability awareness 4
2.6 Scheduled contact hours 5
2.7. Assessment Pattern 5
Section 3: Key General Information **6**
Section 4: Module Organization **7**

Section 1: Key Contacts

Academic Staff Contact Details

	Module Convenor	**Seminar Leader**	**Seminar Leader**
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Student Consultation Hours	Monday 1100-1200 Thursday 1200-1300	Get in touch by email to schedule a meeting.	Get in touch by email to schedule a meeting.
Office Room Number	Sibson 202		
Microsoft Bookings link	Click here to book in		

Professional Services Contact Details

	Email
KBS Programmes Administration Team *For general and administrative queries.*	progadmin@kent.ac.uk
KBS Engagement Support *For support queries including absence, illness, Mitigating Circumstances & extensions.*	KBSsupport@kent.ac.uk

You can find more information on the Professional Services Teams and how they can help you on the KBS Student Hub Moodle Page.

Section 2: Module Overview

2.1. Module Title

Business Skills for a Sustainable Tomorrow

2.2. Synopsis of the Curriculum

Given the startling pace at which human-driven changes are occurring to our social and ecological systems, what skills do you need to be a successful student - ready for whatever challenges await you when you graduate? We'll look at the biggest challenge facing businesses in every field today: how to organize themselves in ways that ensure a sustainable future for the global community. We'll take a case study-based approach to looking at the business-related challenges of the climate crisis and the key theories, concepts, and practices relevant to the sustainability of business today - including the 17 UN Sustainable Development Goals. In doing this, we'll also develop the skills that you need to succeed as you navigate university life and work towards graduation and beyond so that you can make a positive impact the local and global communities to which you belong.

2.3. Learning Outcomes

On successfully completing the module, students will be able to:

1) Define sustainability and discuss its relevance to various societal challenges like our infrastructure, aging populations, or the role of AI in daily life.

2) Identify key issues and challenges relevant to the climate crisis as they impact businesses today and apply key theories and models of sustainable business practice in order to illustrate them.

3) Propose solutions to sustainable challenges that are relevant to their discipline and their own personal context.

4) Reflect on their own employability and the skills that they are expecting to develop at university to prepare them for making a positive impact on both their communities and wider society.

2.4. Developing graduate attributes

Here at KBS we have eight graduate attributes that we know that top employers are looking for. On this module, we take these “skills” as key competencies to develop , looking at a different one each week in order to make sure that we have the skills that we need to face the challenges of tomorrow.

2.5 Developing Ethics and Sustainability awareness

"The University of Kent acknowledges the climate and ecological emergency. The University undertakes to enable radical societal changes necessary to mitigate the causes of global heating and ecological breakdown through education, research, operation, and the influence of the university." You can learning more about what's going on around the University with regards to Sustainability here.

Whether through its explicit subject content, choice of case studies, or similar, this module embeds

sustainability in the curriculum by covering all 17 of the UN Sustainable Development Goals. We'll talk about them explicitly in our lectures, particularly on achieving Net Zero, and discuss them in our seminars. We also assess students' understanding of them in our final essay.

2.6 Scheduled contact hours

Learning hours on this module	**Number of hours**
Contact hours (scheduled classes)	**32**
Assessment Preparation Hours	**55**
Independent study hours	**113**
Total learning hours	**200**

2.7. Assessment Pattern

Assessment	Weighting	Due Date/Deadline Date	Expected Feedback Date
Individual Recorded Presentation – 3 minutes	20	Wednesday 29th October, 2025	Wednesday 19th November, 2025
Blog Post – 500 words	20	Wednesday 19th November, 2025	Wednesday 10th December 2025
Individual Sustainability Essay – 2500 words	60	Wednesday 10th December 2025	Wednesday 14th January 2025

Assessment briefs giving advice and guidance on the marking criteria used to assess each of these assessment types are available on Moodle.

Section 3: Key General Information

There's lots that you need to know about being a KBS student. Fortunately, all of the essential policies and guidance relevant to your studies on this module can be found on the **KBS Student Hub**. It has important information on:

- Submitting your coursework and getting feedback on your work
- Academic Integrity and avoiding plagiarism
- Our policy on the use of Generative AI
- Attendance and Engagement
- Assessment Guidelines (e.g. for Groupwork, Online tests)
- The Research Ethics approval process
- Student Voice and providing feedback on your course

Please do read through these policies carefully and make sure that you understand them and how they apply to you and your assignments on this module.

Section 4: Module Organization

This section details how the module will be taught and what topics will be covered. Details of what these sessions include and any recommended pre-reading can be found on Moodle.

Week	*Lecture topic*	*Seminar topic and readings/texts*
1	*Introduction*	*What's happening where you're from*
2	*AI and Data - Uses and Challenges*	*AI tools – Creating a Code of Conduct*
3	*Sustainability and the Green(washing) challenge*	*How sustainable are we now and what can we do differently?*
4	*Net Zero and the Anthropocene*	*Achieving Net Zero in a complex democracy*
5	*Conflict, Change, and Trade*	*Boardroom in Crisis – Responding to rapid change*
6	*The Changing Demographics of Business*	*A Parliament of Stakeholders facing aging*
7	*Unpacking the UK's productivity puzzle*	*Solving the Productivity Puzzle - Business Case incubator*
8	*Conclusion - The challenges and opportunities of Business in Society*	*Essay Writing Workshop*

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